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Martin's Funerals

Module 3

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF RECEIPT

I hereby acknowledge receipt of the *Martin's Funerals Operations Manual* and confirm that I understand and accept the confidentiality obligations relating to the Martin's Funerals brand, trademarks, trade secrets, copyright, operational know-how, and goodwill, whether currently existing or arising in the future.

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Editions and Copyright

Editions:

1st–2nd Editions: February 1998

3rd Edition: March 2000

4th Edition: November 2000

5th Edition: June 2001

6th Edition: February 2006

7th Edition: May 2007

8th Edition: August 2010

9th Edition: June 2017

10th Edition: January 2026

Publisher: Martin's Funerals Franchising (Pty) Ltd

No provision of this Manual, nor any conduct taken in terms of it, shall be interpreted as limiting, waiving, or excluding any right or protection afforded to a consumer, franchisee, or other protected person under the Consumer Protection Act, 68 of 2008, or any other applicable South African legislation.

All discretionary powers exercised under this Manual shall be applied reasonably, proportionately, and in good faith, and—except where immediate action or objectively necessary is objectively required to prevent serious harm, illegality, or regulatory breach—only after written notice and a reasonable opportunity to remedy, in accordance with section 48 of the Consumer Protection Act, 68 of 2008.

Where technical or legal language is used, it must be interpreted in a manner that is understandable to a reasonable franchisee or consumer, and any ambiguity shall be resolved in favour of fairness, transparency, and consumer protection.

MODULE 1

FRANCHISE GOVERNANCE & BRAND CONTROL

PURPOSE AND AUTHORITY

This module defines the governance framework under which all Martin's Funerals franchises operate.

It establishes the authority of **Martin's Funerals Franchising (Pty) Ltd** ("the Franchisor") and sets out the obligations of all franchisees.

This module must be read together with the Franchise Agreement and all operational modules.

OWNERSHIP OF BRAND AND SYSTEMS

All trademarks, trade names, logos, manuals, systems, and intellectual property remain the exclusive property of the Franchisor.

Franchisees acquire a **limited, non-transferable right of use** for the duration of the Franchise Agreement.

No deviation, modification, or independent branding is permitted without written consent.

FRANCHISEE OBLIGATIONS

Franchisees shall: - Operate strictly in accordance with all franchise manuals - Ensure staff compliance at all times - Protect the reputation and goodwill of the brand - Maintain accurate records and MF Files

Franchisees are responsible for the acts and omissions of their employees and agents.

REPORTING & OVERSIGHT

Franchisees shall submit all required operational, financial, and compliance reports timeously.

The Franchisor reserves the right to inspect premises, records, and operations at any reasonable time.

NON-COMPLIANCE & DISCIPLINARY ACTION

Failure to comply with this manual constitutes a breach of the Franchise Agreement.

The Franchisor may impose corrective measures including: - Written warnings - Mandatory retraining - Financial penalties - Suspension of operations - Termination of the franchise

CONFIDENTIALITY & MANUAL CONTROL

Franchise manuals are confidential documents.

Manuals may not be copied, shared, or disclosed without written permission.

VERSION CONTROL

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: _____

Approved By: Martin's Funerals Franchising (Pty) Ltd

DIGITAL DOCUMENT CONTROL INDEX

Martin's Funerals Franchise System

PURPOSE

This index establishes **formal digital control** over all franchise manuals, policies, handbooks, forms, and templates.

It ensures: - Only the latest approved documents are used - Clear version control - Audit readiness - Protection of confidential franchise material

DOCUMENT CONTROL RULES

All official franchise documents must be: - Digitally stored - Version controlled - Approved by the Franchisor

Printed documents are considered **uncontrolled copies** unless stamped and dated.

No document may be amended locally by a franchisee.

MASTER DOCUMENT REGISTER

Document Name	Module	Version	Effective Date	Owner	Status
Franchise Governance & Brand Control	Module 1	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Administration, Finance & Trust Controls	Module 2	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Operations, Compliance & Service Delivery	Module 3	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Staff Operational Handbook	Module 3A	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Cremation Operations & Compliance	Module 4	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Repatriation & Cross-Border Transport	Module 5	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Training & Assessment Programme	System	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Staff Acknowledgement Forms	Forms	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Incident & Non-Compliance Forms	Forms	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active
Audit Checklist	Forms	1.0	___	Franchisor	Active

VERSION CONTROL PROCESS

All documents must include: - Version number - Effective date - Approval authority

Version changes must be logged:

Date	Document	Old Version	New Version	Reason	Approved By

ACCESS CONTROL

Access levels: - **Level 1:** Franchisor (full control) - **Level 2:** Franchisees (read-only) - **Level 3:** Staff (handbooks only)

Documents must be stored in a secure cloud repository.

DISTRIBUTION & UPDATES

Updates are issued centrally by the Franchisor.

Franchisees must: - Acknowledge receipt of updates - Replace outdated versions immediately

AUDIT CONFIRMATION

During audits, franchisees must demonstrate: - Access to the latest versions - Removal of obsolete documents

FRANCHISE ROLLOUT & ACKNOWLEDGEMENT WORKFLOW

Martin's Funerals Franchise System

PURPOSE

This workflow defines the **official process** for rolling out franchise manuals, updates, and policies, and for obtaining formal acknowledgement from franchisees and staff.

It ensures: - Controlled distribution - Proof of receipt and understanding - Legal and audit defensibility

ROLLOUT TRIGGERS

A rollout is required when: - A new franchise is onboarded - A new module or handbook is issued - An existing module is revised - Legislative or regulatory changes occur

ROLLOUT RESPONSIBILITY

The Franchisor is responsible for: - Approving final documents - Assigning version numbers and effective dates - Issuing rollout notices

Franchisees are responsible for: - Distributing staff-level documents - Ensuring acknowledgements are completed - Replacing outdated documents

OFFICIAL ROLLOUT STEPS

STEP 1: PREPARATION

Final document approved and versioned
Document added to Digital Document Control Index
Previous versions archived

STEP 2: DISTRIBUTION

Documents issued via official digital repository
Rollout notice sent to franchisees
Effective date clearly stated

STEP 3: ACKNOWLEDGEMENT (FRANCHISEES)

Franchisee signs **Franchise Manual Receipt & Compliance Acknowledgement**
Confirmation returned to Franchisor
Record filed centrally

STEP 4: ACKNOWLEDGEMENT (STAFF)

Staff issued relevant handbooks only
Staff sign acknowledgement forms
Forms filed in personnel records

STEP 5: VERIFICATION

Franchisor confirms receipt
Random spot checks conducted

TIMEFRAMES

Franchisee acknowledgement: within **7 days**

Staff acknowledgement: within **14 days**

Failure to comply escalated

NON-COMPLIANCE

Failure to acknowledge: - Constitutes non-compliance - May result in suspension of operations - Will be recorded for audit purposes

RECORD KEEPING

All acknowledgements retained for **minimum 5 years**

Digital copies acceptable

AUDIT CONFIRMATION

During audits, franchisees must demonstrate: - Current manuals in use - Signed acknowledgements on file

MODULE 2

ADMINISTRATION, FINANCE & TRUST CONTROLS

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This module governs all **administrative, financial, and trust-related activities** of Martin's Funerals franchises.

It is designed to protect: - Clients and beneficiaries - Franchisees and staff - The Martin's Funerals brand - Trust and insurance funds

Compliance with this module is **mandatory** and enforceable under the Franchise Agreement.

MF FILE – ADMINISTRATIVE CONTROL

An MF File must be opened for **every transaction and service**, including: - Funerals - Cremations - Pre-arrangements - Insurance claims - Societies and group schemes - Tombstones and memorials

No financial transaction may occur without an MF File.

Each MF File must contain: - Client instructions - Signed agreements - Copies of all receipts and invoices - Certified documents where required

DAILY REPORTING

All monies received must be recorded **daily**.

Daily reports must reflect: - Cash received - Electronic payments - Insurance proceeds - Society contributions - Pre-arrangement payments

Daily reports must reconcile with bank deposits.

BANKING & ACCOUNTS

Each franchise must maintain: - One operational cheque/current account - One trust or savings account for client funds

Under no circumstances may trust funds be mixed with operational funds.

At least 80% of all trust-related receipts must be deposited daily into the trust account.

TRUST FUNDS (CRITICAL CONTROL)

Trust funds include: - Insurance monies - Society and group scheme funds - Pre-arranged funeral payments - Memorial and tombstone deposits

Trust funds **do not belong to the franchisee**.

Trust funds may only be used for their intended purpose.

Detailed trust records must be maintained per client or group.

INSURANCE, SOCIETIES & PRE-ARRANGEMENTS

Separate MF Files must be maintained for each policy, society, or group.

Joining fees and administration fees must be recorded separately.

Under no circumstances may insurance funds be mixed with operational funds.

Annual price increases must be disclosed in writing and acknowledged by clients.

No verbal agreements are permitted.

PAYMENTS, RECEIPTS & INVOICING

Every payment received must be supported by a receipt or tax invoice.

Every payment made must be supported by a valid invoice or receipt.

All documentation must be filed in the MF File.

AUDITS & INSPECTIONS

Trust accounts must be auditable at all times.

The Franchisor reserves the right to: - Inspect financial records - Audit trust accounts - Require corrective action

NON-COMPLIANCE & CONSEQUENCES

Misuse of trust funds constitutes **serious misconduct**.

Consequences may include: - Disciplinary action - Franchise suspension - Termination - Legal action

VERSION CONTROL

Version: 1.0

Effective Date: _____

Approved By: Martin's Funerals Franchising (Pty) Ltd

STAFF CASH-HANDLING HANDBOOK

(Mandatory for All Staff Handling Money)

PURPOSE

This handbook sets out **clear rules** for handling money at Martin's Funerals. These rules protect staff, clients, and the business. Failure to comply may result in disciplinary action, including dismissal.

CORE CASH RULES

Never accept money without issuing a receipt
Never delay issuing a receipt
Never mix personal money with company money
Never borrow from the till
Never keep client money overnight unless authorised

RECEIPTS

Every payment **must** have a receipt
Receipts must show:
Date
Amount
Client name
MF File number
Receipt books must be controlled by management

CASH STORAGE

Cash must be stored in a locked drawer or safe
Access is limited to authorised staff only

DEPOSITS

Cash must be deposited **daily** where possible
Trust-related money must go to the trust account
Never delay trust deposits

PROHIBITED ACTIONS

You may never: - Accept bribes or tips - Alter receipts - Issue receipts later - Use cash for expenses

IF YOU ARE UNSURE

Stop
Ask your supervisor
Never guess

MODULE 3

OPERATIONS, COMPLIANCE & SERVICE DELIVERY

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This module forms an integral part of the Martin's Funerals Franchise Operations Manual.

It sets out **mandatory operational rules, statutory compliance requirements, service delivery standards, and ethical obligations** applicable to all franchisees, managers, employees, contractors, and agents operating under the Martin's Funerals brand.

Compliance with this module is **compulsory**. Failure to adhere to any provision herein constitutes a **material breach of the Franchise Agreement** and may result in corrective action, penalties, suspension, or termination.

GOVERNING PRINCIPLES

All services must be rendered in accordance with: - Applicable South African legislation and regulations - Industry best practice - The dignity of the deceased - Compassion and respect toward bereaved families - The protection of the Martin's Funerals brand
Franchisees are personally accountable for ensuring staff compliance.

MF FILE MANAGEMENT (MANDATORY)

An MF File must be opened and completed in every case without exception.

The MF File constitutes the official legal, operational, and audit record of the funeral.

No removal, preparation, burial, cremation, or ancillary service may proceed unless the MF File has been properly opened.

All documentation must: - Be attached on the right-hand side of the blue MF File - Be secured with **one staple only** - Be signed, dated, and certified where required

LEGAL CERTIFICATION OF DEATH (DHA-1663)

A registered medical practitioner **must personally examine the deceased** prior to completing and signing the DHA-1663.

The DHA-1663 is ordinarily completed at: - A Government Mortuary - A hospital or hospice - A Martin's Funerals mortuary

If a deceased is received without a completed DHA-1663, the franchisee shall: - Arrange for the assisting doctor to attend the Martin's Funerals mortuary - Record all communication in the MF File - Inform the family of their responsibility and associated costs - Obtain written family acknowledgement

Under no circumstances may a deceased be transported to a doctor's consulting rooms, parking areas, or any unauthorised location for examination.

A deceased may only be removed from the mortuary with **written family consent**.

REMOVAL OF THE DECEASED – OPERATIONAL SUB-MODULE

All removals must be conducted with professionalism, discretion, and respect.

Staff shall be formally dressed at all times.

Mandatory equipment includes: - Completed MF File and removal instruction - Toe tag - Clean trolley, linen, protective sheets - Surgical gloves and disinfectant - Clean, roadworthy vehicle

On arrival at the place of death: - Introduce yourself and explain the process - Address the deceased respectfully by name or relationship -

Remove jewellery in the presence of family and obtain confirmation - Complete and attach the toe tag in front of the family

Smoking in the presence or vicinity of the family is strictly prohibited.

MORTUARY PROCEDURES & HYGIENE SUB-MODULE

All mortuary operations must comply with Department of Health regulations.

Protective clothing is mandatory at all times.

Procedures include: - Booking into the mortuary register - Full cleansing and disinfection of the deceased - Secure identification of all clothing and personal effects - Immediate sanitation of equipment and vehicles

Refrigeration must be maintained between **0°C and 3°C**.

DOCUMENT CONTROL & RECORD KEEPING SUB-MODULE

No document may leave the office unless signed for by the recipient.

Certified copies of all critical documents must be retained in the MF File.

Core documents include: - DHA-1663 - BI-14 - BI-20 / BI-5 - Removal instructions - Permissions for embalming, cremation, transport, or repatriation

NATURAL AND UNNATURAL DEATH PROCEDURES SUB-MODULE

Natural deaths involve no suspicion of foul play and do not require a compulsory post-mortem.

Unnatural deaths include homicide, suicide, accidents, or unexplained causes.

Martin's Funerals personnel may not remove a body from the scene of an unnatural death.

Such cases must be transferred to a Government Mortuary and handled by authorities.

CREMATION COMPLIANCE SUB-MODULE

Cremation requires strict compliance with statutory schedules A–E.

Documentation requirements differ between natural and unnatural deaths and must be confirmed with the crematorium.

Families must be guided sensitively while ensuring legal compliance.

REPATRIATION & CROSS-BORDER TRANSPORT SUB-MODULE

Requirements vary by consulate, airline, and border authority.

Bodies must be embalmed and sealed in approved coffins.

Original documents must accompany the remains, with certified copies retained.

SERVICE LEVEL DEFINITIONS SUB-MODULE

Recognised service categories include: - Collection / Coffin Service - Full Funeral Service - O.B.O. (On Behalf Of) - Cremation Services - Pauper Funerals

Services must be delivered strictly as contracted and documented.

FINANCIAL CONTROLS & TRUST FUNDS SUB-MODULE

All monies received must be recorded and receipted.

Insurance, society, and pre-arranged funds **do not belong to the franchisee**.

A dedicated trust or savings account is mandatory.

At least **80% of such funds must be deposited daily**.

PRE-PLANNING & PRE-ARRANGEMENTS SUB-MODULE

Pre-arrangements must be documented, signed, and reviewed annually.

Customers must acknowledge potential price increases.

These arrangements must be handled with absolute integrity.

EXHUMATIONS SUB-MODULE

Exhumations require written authorisation from all relevant authorities.

Strict health, safety, and documentation controls apply.

Full sterilisation after exhumation is mandatory.

PAUPER FUNERALS SUB-MODULE

Pauper funerals may only be conducted with official written authority.

Services must be rendered with dignity and respect equal to any other funeral.

RELIGIOUS & CULTURAL PRACTICES

Franchisees must familiarise themselves with religious and cultural customs.

Relevant clergy or cultural leaders must be consulted prior to finalising arrangements.

TOMBSTONES & MEMORIALS SUB-MODULE

Tombstone sales require written specifications and signed family approval.

All financial transactions must be fully documented.

Martin's Funerals provides **no warranties** on tombstones.

ETHICS & PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

All personnel shall act with honesty, empathy, confidentiality, and professionalism at all times.

MODULE 3A
STAFF OPERATIONAL HANDBOOK
(Mandatory Compliance)

PURPOSE OF THIS HANDBOOK

This handbook provides **clear, practical instructions** for all Martin's Funerals staff, including drivers, removals teams, mortuary assistants, and administrative personnel.

It explains **what you must do, how to do it, and what you must never do**. These rules protect: - The dignity of the deceased - The emotional wellbeing of families - Your own safety - The Martin's Funerals name

Failure to follow these rules may result in disciplinary action.

CORE RULES (NON-NEGOTIABLE)

MF FILE

Every case **must** have an MF File

Never remove or handle a deceased without a file

All forms must be completed fully and neatly

RESPECT & CONDUCT

Always behave calmly, respectfully, and professionally

Never joke, rush, or behave casually around families

Never refer to the deceased as "the body" in front of family

Always use the person's name or family relationship

APPEARANCE

Dress as if attending a church service

Uniform or jacket must be clean

No smoking where families can see or smell you

REMOVAL OF THE DECEASED – STEP BY STEP

BEFORE YOU LEAVE

Take with you: - MF File and removal instruction - Toe tag - Clean trolley, linen, plastic sheet, pillow - Gloves (minimum 3 pairs) - Disinfectant and air freshener - Clean vehicle

ON ARRIVAL

Leave equipment in the vehicle initially

Introduce yourself politely

Explain what you are going to do

Offer comfort (prayer if appropriate)

PREPARING THE DECEASED

Ask permission before undressing

Remove jewellery **in front of a family member**

Hand jewellery directly to the family and acknowledge receipt thereof in writing.

Fold clothing neatly

Ask where clothing must be placed

TOE TAG (VERY IMPORTANT)

Complete all details clearly

Let a family member check and sign it

Attach toe tag in front of the family

LEAVING THE PREMISES

Cover the deceased respectfully

Say goodbye to the family

Place deceased in vehicle

Return directly to the mortuary

WHAT YOU MUST NEVER DO

Never take a deceased to a doctor's rooms or parking area
Never remove a deceased without family permission
Never remove a body from an unnatural death scene
Never accept jewellery or personal items
Never smoke near families
Never speak about post-mortem results

MORTUARY PROCEDURES

ON ARRIVAL AT THE MORTUARY

Change into protective clothing
Book the deceased into the mortuary register
Never remove or lose the toe tag

BODY PREPARATION

Clean the body with water and disinfectant
Close eyes and mouth gently
Prop the neck correctly
Cover body from shoulders to knees

STORAGE

Ensure freezer temperature is between **0°C and 3°C**
Label all clothing and belongings clearly

HYGIENE & SAFETY

You must wear: - Gloves - Apron - Mask - Gumboots (where required)
After each removal: - Clean and disinfect trolley - Clean vehicle loading area - Dispose of waste correctly

UNNATURAL DEATHS (IMPORTANT)

If death is: - Sudden - Violent - Unexplained
THEN: - **DO NOT TOUCH OR REMOVE THE BODY** - Contact your supervisor immediately - The body must go to a Government Mortuary

DOCUMENTS

Never give documents to anyone without signature
Always return documents to the office
Certified copies must stay in the MF File

PROFESSIONAL ETHICS

Keep all information confidential
Show patience and empathy
Ask if you are unsure — never guess

REMEMBER

To us, it is a job.
To the family, it is one of the worst days of their lives.
Treat every case with care, dignity, and respect.

MODULE 4

CREMATION OPERATIONS & COMPLIANCE

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This module governs all cremation-related services provided by Martin's Funerals franchises. Cremation is a **high-risk, highly regulated service** and requires strict legal compliance.

GENERAL PRINCIPLES

No cremation may proceed without full statutory compliance.
Sensitivity and dignity toward families is mandatory.

LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

Required statutory documents include Schedules A–E, depending on the nature of death.
Documentation differs between natural and unnatural deaths and must be confirmed with the crematorium.
Incomplete documentation **must halt the cremation process**.

UNNATURAL DEATHS

Unnatural deaths require post-mortem clearance before cremation.
Written authority from the relevant authority is mandatory.

IDENTIFICATION & VERIFICATION

Identity verification must be completed prior to cremation.
The MF File must contain all verification records.

ASHES HANDLING

Ashes must be clearly labelled and logged.
Release of ashes requires written family authorisation.

RECORD KEEPING

All cremation documentation must be retained in the MF File.

NON-COMPLIANCE

Any deviation constitutes serious misconduct.

MODULE 5

REPATRIATION & CROSS-BORDER TRANSPORT

PURPOSE AND RISK CONTEXT

This module governs the repatriation of deceased persons within South Africa and across international borders. Repatriation is a **high-risk operational activity** involving legal, health, and diplomatic compliance.

GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

No repatriation may proceed without full written authority.

Requirements vary by country, airline, consulate, and border authority.

Franchisees shall verify requirements **before** accepting instructions.

EMBALMING & COFFIN REQUIREMENTS

Embalming is mandatory for cross-border transport unless expressly waived in writing.

Approved zinc-lined or sealed coffins must be used.

DOCUMENTATION

Documentation may include: - DHA-1663 - Death certificate - Embalming certificate - Export permit - Consular clearance - Airline documentation

All originals must accompany the deceased; copies must remain in the MF File.

TRANSPORT & HANDOVER

Chain-of-custody must be maintained at all times.

Written confirmation of handover is mandatory.

NON-COMPLIANCE

Any deviation constitutes serious misconduct.

TRANSPORT OF HUMAN ASHES

1. Do you need an export or import permit?

In most countries:

- No export permit required
- No import permit required

Ashes are no longer considered a “biological risk”.

However, you **must** have the following documents:

- Death certificate
- Cremation certificate (from the crematorium)
- A declaration confirming that the ashes are indeed those of the deceased (sometimes included with the cremation certificate)

2. How are the ashes transported?

Option A — As personal baggage on an aircraft

- The urn must be in a suitable container (not metal — X-rays must be able to pass through)
- Documents must travel with the urn
- Some airlines require prior notification, but not always

Option B — As cargo (like a package)

This is done via:

- Specialized courier companies, or
- Air freight services arranged through a funeral director

Option C — By post (certain countries)

Some countries allow this via registered mail, but many European countries require transport by air and personal carriage.

3. What about the receiving country in Europe?

In most EU countries, you may enter with ashes without difficulty, provided you have:

- Death certificate

- Cremation certificate

However, a few countries have additional rules:

- **Germany** has strict burial regulations and often requires that a funeral director in Germany receive the ashes
- **France** sometimes requires a declaration stating the purpose of transport
- **Italy and Spain** are usually less strict, but may sometimes require prior notification of the receiving person/family member

DOCUMENTS REQUIRED FOR REPATRIATIONS

Below is the standard list of documentation required for Europe:

Required from South Africa:

1. Official death certificate

- Obtained from the Department of Home Affairs (usually arranged by the funeral director)
- Sometimes required in English or officially sworn-translated

2. Medical certificate stating cause of death

- Issued by a doctor or hospital
- In some cases, a post-mortem report is also required

3. Non-infectious disease certificate / "Non-infectious disease letter"

A doctor or medical facility confirms that the death was not caused by a contagious disease

Also known as:

- "No contagious disease letter"
- "Non-infectious declaration"
- This document confirms that the deceased did not die from a dangerous or contagious disease

4. Embalming declaration / Embalming certificate

- Issued by the responsible mortuary
- Proof that the body has been professionally embalmed according to international standards
- The consulate pays particular attention to the technical specifications of the embalming

5. Document confirming correct packaging and sealing of the body

- Provided by the mortuary and repatriation company
- Proof that the body is transported in a sealed container / zinc lining / leak-proof coffin

6. Travel permit / Human remains export permit

Obtained from the relevant human remains or health authority (arranged by the funeral director)

- Usually issued by the Department of Health
- Applied for by the funeral director

7. Identification documents of the deceased

- Passport or ID
- Flight details
- Airline
- Airway bill (AWB)
- Date and route of transport
- Contact details of sender and receiver

8. Proof of family relationship / power of attorney for consent

- Declaration confirming the person is legally authorised to move the body
- Contact details of the funeral director in Europe
- Name and address of the receiving facility
- Sometimes a confirmation letter stating that the body will legally be received in the destination country

Required for the receiving country in Europe:

(Requirements vary slightly by country, e.g. the Netherlands, Germany, Italy, etc.)

1. Import permit for human remains (if required)

2. Doctor's certificate in English or in the language of the receiving country
3. Copy of the deceased's passport
4. Arrival arrangements at the receiving airport
 - a. The body is usually collected by a local European funeral director
5. **Important:** most countries require that **all documents** be translated into English or an official EU language

Where do you obtain the documents?

1. Death certificate → Department of Home Affairs
2. Non-infectious certificate → Treating doctor / hospital
3. Embalming certificate → Mortuary
4. Import/export permits → Arranged by the funeral director
5. Translations → Sworn translator (repatriation agencies usually have their own)

Export permit from South Africa

The funeral director obtains this from:

1. Department of Health (National Department of Health) or the relevant Provincial Health Authority
2. In some cases, it must be stamped by the State Pathologist / Forensic Services
3. It is usually applied for by the funeral director via specialised repatriation channels, not as a standard public application
4. **Important:** a private individual cannot apply for this permit themselves — it must be done by a registered repatriation or funeral director

Import permit for the receiving country

The funeral director obtains this through:

1. Communication with the funeral director or repatriation agent in the European receiving country
2. Or via the embassy / consulate of that country in South Africa
3. Some European countries do not require an import permit but do require the following:
4. Death certificate in English
5. Non-infectious disease certificate
6. Embalming certificate
7. Packaging and sealing document
8. Passport or identity document of the deceased
9. Each country's requirements differ slightly

Practical process:

1. South African funeral director requests the export permit from the SA Department of Health
2. SA funeral director sends documents to the EU funeral director
3. EU funeral director applies for the import permit or confirms that none is required
4. Both parties sign off on the documentation
5. The body is booked on a cargo flight

What the consulate actually checks:

1. Is the death legally certified?
2. Is there no biological risk?
3. Is the embalming valid according to international standards?
4. Is the packaging leak-proof and safe?
5. Is the transport legal and properly documented?
6. Is there a legal party receiving the body in the destination country?

EU Country-specific notes (brief)

- **Germany:** very strict — requires additional documentation and legal declarations
- **France:** often requires sworn translations
- **Netherlands:** highly standardised and efficient, but strict on embalming
- **Italy:** usually requires additional government authorisation
- **Spain:** simpler, but the recipient must be a registered funeral director

Compile one document pack for the consulate in this order:

1. Death certificate
2. Medical certificate
3. Non-infectious letter
4. Embalming certificate
5. Packaging/Sealing certificate
6. Export permit
7. ID/passport copies
8. Flight details
9. Family consent
10. Confirmation of receiving funeral service/company

1. FAMILY AUTHORITY LETTER

FAMILY AUTHORITY LETTER FOR OVERSEAS REPATRIATION (copy on your letterhead)

Date:

To:

[Embassy / Consulate / Airline / Insurance Company / Repatriation Service Name]

Address:

Subject: Family Authority for Repatriation

Full Name of Authorising Family Member:

Identity/Passport Number:

Relationship to the individual:

Residential Address:

I, hereby formally confirm that I am an immediate family member and authorised representative of:

Full Name of Person Being Repatriated:

Date of Birth:

Passport Number:

Current Location: South Africa

I hereby grant full authority and consent for the repatriation of the above-named individual from **South Africa** to **[Destination Country]**, including all necessary travel, medical, administrative, and logistical arrangements required for this process.

This authority includes, but is not limited to:

- Coordination with airlines, medical providers, insurers, and government authorities
- Completion and submission of required documentation
- Consent for travel arrangements and associated procedures

I confirm that this consent is given voluntarily and without restriction, and that I accept responsibility for this authorisation.

Should any additional information or verification be required, I may be contacted at:

Phone:

Email:

Yours faithfully,

Full Name:

Signature:

Date:

Witness:

Full Name:

Signature:

Date:

Notary / Commissioner of Oaths:

Name & Stamp:

1.1 EMBASSY FAMILY AUTHORITY LETTER (copy on your letterhead)

FAMILY AUTHORITY LETTER

(Authorising a family member or funeral home to act on behalf of the family)

FAMILY AUTHORITY LETTER

I,
(Full Name)
Identity/Passport Number:
residing at:

hereby authorise:

Name: **MARTIN'S FUNERALS**
Address:
Contact Details
Relationship to Deceased: **FUNERAL HOME**

to act on behalf of our family regarding all matters related to the passing of:

Full Name of Deceased:
ID/Passport Number:
Date of Death:
Place of Death: (country of origin)

This authority includes, but is not limited to:

- Obtaining the Portuguese death certificate
- Arranging apostille and translations
- Liaising with the South African Embassy/Consulate
- Submitting documents to the South African Department of Home Affairs
- Signing required forms
- Arranging repatriation of the remains/ashes (if applicable)

Signed at _____ on this _____ day of _____ 20____.

Signature of Authorising Family Member

Signature of Person Receiving Authority

2. DECLARATION OF PACKAGING AND SEALING OF HUMAN REMAINS (copy on your letterhead)

DECLARATION OF PACKAGING AND SEALING OF HUMAN REMAINS –INTERNATIONAL TRANSPORT

Name of Deceased:

ID/Passport Number:

Date of Death:

Location of Remains:

This document serves to certify that the human remains of the above-named deceased have been professionally prepared, packaged, and sealed in accordance with all applicable international repatriation, health, and transportation standards for the safe movement of human remains.

1. Embalming

- The deceased has been fully embalmed according to international requirements.
- Embalming completed on:
- Performed by (facility name):

2. Internal Packaging

- The remains have been placed in an inner, sealable body bag and securely closed.
- No leakage, biological contamination, or fluid release is present.

3. External Packaging / Coffin

- The remains have been placed in a coffin containing a sealed zinc/metal liner or hermetically sealed container.
- The seal is **airtight and leak-proof**, compliant with international transportation standards for human remains.

4. Final Sealing

- The coffin has been officially sealed by the funeral home/mortuary on:
- Seal number(s) (if applicable):

5. Health & Safety Compliance

- According to the attending medical officer, the deceased did **not** suffer from any communicable or infectious disease that poses a public-health risk.
- The packaging has been prepared to prevent any leakage, odour release, or gas expansion during transport.

Declaration

Funeral Director / Repatriation Agent:

Name:

Company: **MARTIN'S FUNERALS**

Registration Number:

Contact Number:

Email:

I, the undersigned, hereby declare that the above information is accurate and true, and that all necessary protocols for the safe and lawful international transport of these remains have been adhered to.

Signature:

Name & Title:

Date:

Company Stamp:

2.1 EMBASSY DECLARATION OF PACKAGING AND SEALING OF HUMAN REMAINS (copy on your letterhead)

DECLARATION OF PACKAGING AND SEALING OF HUMAN REMAINS FOR INTERNATIONAL TRANSPORT

This is to certify that the remains of:

Full Name of Deceased:

Date of Birth:

Date of Death:

Place of Death: (South Africa)

have been properly prepared for international air transport in accordance with international health and aviation regulations.

The body has been:

- Embalmed in accordance with international standards
- Placed in a hermetically sealed zinc/metal-lined coffin
- Placed in an outer wooden coffin
- Sealed to prevent leakage
- Labelled with full identification details
- Inspected and approved for international transport

Funeral Home Name: **MARTIN'S FUNERALS**

Address:

Phone:

Name of Responsible Person:

Position:

I hereby certify that all procedures comply with IATA and international mortuary regulations.

Signed at _____ on this _____ day of _____ 20____.

Signature:

Name:

Position:

Funeral Home Stamp: _____

3.1 EMBASSY FAMILY CONSENT LETTER FOR THE INTERNATIONAL TRANSPORT (copy on your letterhead)

FAMILY CONSENT FOR REPATRIATION OF HUMAN REMAINS

We, the undersigned family of:

Full Name of Deceased:

ID/Passport Number:

hereby give full consent for the repatriation of the remains/cremated ashes from **South Africa to (country of origin)**.

Next-of-Kin Name:

ID/Passport Number:

Relationship to Deceased:

We understand and accept all arrangements, costs, and processes involved in international repatriation.

Signed at _____ on this _____ day of _____ 20____.

Signature of Next-of-Kin

Witness Signature

4.1 FUNERAL HOME LETTER FOR AIRLINES - DOCUMENTS NEEDED

AIRLINE DOCUMENT CHECKLIST

Transport of Human Remains / Cremated Ashes

Mandatory (Almost Always Required)

1. **Official Death Certificate**
 - Issued by the relevant civil authority
 - Certified copy (often stamped)
2. **Passport of the Deceased**
 - Original or certified copy
 - Some airlines require passport cancellation proof
3. **Funeral Home Letter / Handling Confirmation**
 - On official letterhead
 - Confirms custody, preparation, and transport responsibility
4. **Embalming Certificate** (*for human remains*)
 - Confirms embalming method and date
 - Must state remains are safe for air transport
 - **Not required for ashes**
5. **Cremation Certificate** (*for ashes*)
 - Issued by crematorium
 - Confirms cremation date and identity
6. **Non-Contagious Disease Certificate / Medical Certificate**
 - Confirms cause of death is not from a communicable disease
 - Often signed by a medical practitioner or health authority

Transport & Packaging Documents

7. **Sealing Certificate**
 - Confirms coffin/urn sealing method
 - Includes liner type (zinc, hermetically sealed, etc.)
8. **Coffin / Urn Specification Certificate**
 - Confirms compliance with **IATA and airline cargo regulations**
 - Material, dimensions, and leak-proof lining
9. **Air Waybill (AWB)** (*Cargo shipments*)
 - Issued by airline or appointed cargo agent

Consular & Legal Documents (Common for International Flights)

10. **Export Permit / Out of Country Permit**
 - Issued by local authority or health department
11. **Consular Mortuary Certificate** (*if required by destination country*)
 - Issued by embassy or consulate
12. **Import Permit** (*destination country specific*)
 - Required by some countries

Authorization & Family Documents

13. **Next-of-Kin Authorization Letter**
 - Permits transport and handling

- Sometimes notarized

14. **Copy of Next-of-Kin Passport / ID**

Additional (Airline / Country Dependent)

- 15. **Police Clearance** (*unnatural or accidental deaths*)
 - 16. **Post-Mortem Report** (*if applicable*)
 - 17. **Transit Country Permits** (*if routing via another country*)
 - 18. **Translation of Documents**
 - Often required in **English** or destination country language
-
- Airlines usually require **scanned copies 48–72 hours before departure**
 - Originals travel **with the remains**
 - Always verify **destination country rules** — they override airline policy

4.2 FUNERAL HOME LETTER FOR EMBASSY (copy on your letterhead)

THE CONSULAR OFFICER

To: The Consular Officer
[Name of Embassy]
[City, Country]

Subject: Confirmation of Funeral Arrangements and Repatriation

Dear Sir / Madam,

We hereby confirm that **[Full Name of Deceased]**, holder of passport number **[Passport Number]**, date of birth **[DOB]**, passed away on **[Date of Death]** in **[City, Country]**.

Our funeral home, **MARTIN'S FUNERALS**, has been formally appointed by the next of kin, **[Full Name of Next of Kin]**, to handle all funeral arrangements, including the **preparation, documentation, and repatriation of the deceased's remains** to **[Destination Country]**.

The deceased is currently in our care at **MARTIN'S FUNERALS AT** _____. All procedures are being carried out in accordance with local health regulations and international repatriation requirements.

We respectfully request the Embassy's assistance with the necessary consular documentation, including but not limited to the **mortuary certificate, consular death registration, and any permits required for international repatriation**.

Should you require any additional information or supporting documentation, please do not hesitate to contact us.

Yours faithfully,

Full Name: _____
Title, e.g., Funeral Director: _____
Funeral Home Name: _____
Telephone Number: _____
Email Address: _____
Physical Address: _____

Official Stamp, if applicable

4.3 FUNERAL HOME LETTER FOR AIRLINES (copy on your letterhead)

CARGO / SPECIAL ASSISTANCE DEPARTMENT

To: Cargo / Special Assistance Department
[Airline Name]

Subject: Confirmation of Human Remains Transport – Funeral Home Authorization

Dear Sir / Madam,

This letter serves to confirm that **MARTIN'S FUNERALS** has been officially appointed to handle the funeral arrangements and **air transport of the remains** of:

Full Name of Deceased:

Date of Birth:

Date of Death:

Passport Number:

The deceased is currently in our care at **[Full Address]**. All preparation, documentation, and packaging of the remains will be conducted in **full compliance with local health regulations, International Air Transport Association standards, and the airline's cargo requirements.**

The remains are scheduled to be transported from **[Departure Airport, Country]** to **[Arrival Airport, Country]** on **[Proposed Date of Travel]**, subject to airline approval and final documentation.

All required documentation, including the **death certificate, embalming or cremation certificate, non-contagious disease declaration, sealing certificate, and export permits**, will be provided prior to departure.

Should you require any further information or additional documentation, please contact us using the details below.

Yours faithfully,

Full Name:

Title, e.g., Funeral Director:

Funeral Home Name:

Telephone Number:

Email Address:

Physical Address:

Official Stamp / Registration Number

4.4 EMBASSY FUNERAL HOME LETTER FOR EMBASSY AND AIRLINES (copy on your letterhead)

FUNERAL HOME CONFIRMATION LETTER FOR INTERNATIONAL REPATRIATION

To Whom It May Concern,

This letter serves to confirm that the remains of:

Full Name of Deceased:

Date of Death:

Place of Death: (South Africa)

have been fully prepared for international repatriation to South Africa.

The coffin meets all International Air Transport Association and international health regulations, and all documentation required for air transport is complete, including:

- Embalming certificate
- Hermetically sealed coffin confirmation
- Non-infectious status (if applicable)
- Death certificate (original)
- Apostille
- English translation
- Transit permit (if issued locally)

Funeral Home:

Address:

Contact Details:

Signed at _____ on this _____ day of _____ 20____.

Name:

Position:

Funeral Home Stamp:

5. AFFIDAVIT FOR HOME AFFAIRS FOR REPATRIATION OVERSEAS (copy on your letterhead)

AFFIDAVIT FOR REPATRIATION OF HUMAN REMAINS – HOME AFFAIRS

I, the undersigned:

Full Name:

ID / Passport Number:

Nationality:

Residential Address:

Contact Number:

Email Address:

do hereby make oath and state as follows:

1. I am the **[relationship to the deceased – e.g., parent / spouse / child / next of kin]** of the deceased, and I am duly authorized to make this affidavit and act on behalf of the family regarding the repatriation of the deceased's mortal remains.
2. The deceased's details are as follows:
 - ☐ **Full Name of Deceased:**
 - ☐ **Date of Birth:**
 - ☐ **Date of Death:**
 - ☐ **Place of Death:**
 - ☐ **ID / Passport Number:**
 - ☐ **Nationality:**
3. I hereby authorize **MARTIN'S FUNERALS**, with physical address: **[Full Address]**, and contact number: **[Contact Number]**, to manage all arrangements related to the **repatriation of the deceased overseas**, including preparation, embalming, sealing of the coffin, documentation, and transport.
4. The intended country of final destination is:
Country:
City / Town:
5. I confirm that the funeral home has provided me with the following documents, which will be submitted to the relevant authorities, including Home Affairs, the Embassy, and the airline:
 - ☐ Death Certificate (DHA-1663)
 - ☐ Embalming Certificate
 - ☐ Non-Contagious Disease Certificate
 - ☐ Coffin Sealing Certificate
 - ☐ Passport of the deceased
 - ☐ Funeral Home Letter of Authorization
 - ☐ Any additional documents required by Home Affairs, the Embassy, or the airline
6. I declare that all the information provided herein is **true and correct**, and I have no objection to the funeral home carrying out the repatriation process in accordance with legal, health, and international regulations.
7. This affidavit is made for submission to the **Department of Home Affairs, the relevant Embassy / Consulate, airline authorities, and any other institution requiring same**, in support of the repatriation application.

DEPONENT:

FULL NAME:

SIGNATURE:

DATE:

PLACE:

COMMISSIONER OF OATHS

I certify that the Deponent has acknowledged that they know and understand the contents of this affidavit, which was signed and sworn to before me at:

PLACE: _____

DATE: _____

COMMISSIONER OF OATHS

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Designation & Stamp: _____

5.1 EMBASSY AFFIDAVIT FOR HOME AFFAIRS FOR REPATRIATION OVERSEAS (copy on your letterhead)

AFFIDAVIT FOR HOME AFFAIRS: FOREIGN DEATH REGISTRATION

I, the undersigned:

Full Name:

ID / Passport Number:

Nationality:

Residential Address:

Contact Number:

Email Address:

do hereby make oath and state as follows:

1. That (Full Name of Deceased),
2. ID/Passport Number:
passed away in South Africa on the _____ day of _____ 20_____.
3. The death was registered in South Africa, and an **official death certificate** has been issued.
4. The death certificate has been **apostilled** and **translated into English** as required by South African law.
5. I request that the Department of Home Affairs update the **National Population Register** to reflect the death.
6. I make this affidavit in support of submitting foreign death documentation for official purposes.

Signed and sworn at _____ on this _____ day of _____ 20_____.

Signature of Deponent

Commissioner of Oaths
Name, Stamp & Rank

6. FUNERAL HOME LETTER OF AUTHORIZATION FOR REPATRIATION (copy on your letterhead)

FUNERAL HOME LETTER OF AUTHORIZATION FOR REPATRIATION

Name of Funeral Home: **MARTIN'S FUNERALS**

Physical Address:

City / Province:

Contact Number:

Email:

Date:

To Whom It May Concern,

RE: Repatriation of Deceased – **[Full Name of Deceased]**

We, MARTIN'S FUNERALS, hereby confirm that we have been authorized by the next of kin / legal representative of the deceased, **[Full Name of Deceased]**, to manage and facilitate the repatriation of the deceased's mortal remains overseas.

Deceased Details:

- Full Name:
- Date of Birth:
- Date of Death:
- Place of Death:
- ID / Passport Number:

Next of Kin / Authorizing Person Details:

- Full Name:
- Relationship to Deceased:
- Contact Number:

Destination Country:

City / Town:

As the registered funeral service provider, we confirm that we will handle all arrangements required for international transport of the deceased, including:

1. Preparation and embalming of the body according to legal and health regulations
2. Issuing necessary documentation for Home Affairs, airline, and Embassy purposes
3. Sealing of the coffin in compliance with international regulations
4. Coordinating with airline and authorities to ensure safe and lawful repatriation

We further confirm that the above instructions were given to us voluntarily by the next of kin, and that all actions will comply with South African legislation and international requirements for the repatriation of human remains.

This letter is issued to facilitate submission to the Department of Home Affairs, the relevant Embassy / Consulate, and airline authorities.

Authorized Signatory (MARTIN'S FUNERALS):

Name:

Position:

Signature:

Date:

Official Stamp / Seal of Funeral Home

FRANCHISE TRAINING & ASSESSMENT PROGRAMME

(Mandatory for All Franchisees & Staff)

PURPOSE

This programme ensures that all franchisees, managers, and staff: - Understand their responsibilities - Can demonstrate compliance - Are assessed before independent duty

TRAINING TIERS

TIER 1 – FRANCHISEE & MANAGER (MANDATORY)

Modules Covered: - Module 1 (Governance) - Module 2 (Administration & Finance) - Module 3 (Operations & Compliance)

Assessment: - Written assessment - Scenario-based compliance questions - Signed declaration of understanding

TIER 2 – OPERATIONAL STAFF

Modules Covered: - Module 3A (Staff Handbook) - Removal Protocols - Mortuary Hygiene & Safety

Assessment: - Checklist demonstration - Supervisor sign-off - Annual refresher required

ASSESSMENT EXAMPLES

SAMPLE QUESTIONS (STAFF)

May a deceased ever be taken to a doctor's rooms? (Yes / No)

Who signs the toe tag?

What must you do if death appears unnatural?

SAMPLE QUESTIONS (MANAGEMENT)

Define a material breach of the franchise agreement.

What percentage of trust money must be deposited daily?

When is an MF File mandatory?

CERTIFICATION

Certificates issued upon successful completion

Records kept in personnel files

Failure requires retraining

DISCIPLINARY LINKAGE

Training compliance is linked to performance reviews

Repeated failure may result in suspension

REVIEW CYCLE

Annual review

Immediate updates after legislative change

STAFF ACKNOWLEDGEMENT & COMPLIANCE FORMS

(Mandatory – To Be Filed in Personnel Records)

FORM A: STAFF ACKNOWLEDGEMENT OF OPERATIONS & CONDUCT

I, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that:

I have received, read, and understood **Module 3A – Staff Operational Handbook** of Martin's Funerals.

I understand that compliance with the rules, procedures, and standards contained therein is **mandatory**.

I understand that failure to comply may result in disciplinary action, including dismissal.

I agree to perform my duties with dignity, respect, confidentiality, and professionalism at all times.

Staff Member Details

Full Name:			
ID Number:			
Position:			
Branch:			
Signature:		Date:	
Supervisor Name:			
Supervisor Signature:		Date:	

FORM B: REMOVAL & MORTUARY SAFETY DECLARATION

I acknowledge that:

I have been trained in removal, mortuary, and hygiene procedures

I understand the risks associated with handling deceased persons

I agree to wear protective clothing as instructed

I confirm that I am medically fit to perform my duties

I further confirm that I understand **unnatural death procedures** and that I may not remove a body from such a scene.

Staff Name:			
Signature:			
Supervisor Signature:		Date:	

FORM C: CONFIDENTIALITY & INFORMATION HANDLING AGREEMENT

I understand that:

All information relating to deceased persons and families is confidential

I may not disclose information to unauthorised persons

Breach of confidentiality constitutes serious misconduct

Staff Name:			
Signature:		Date:	

INCIDENT & NON-COMPLIANCE REPORTING FORMS

(Mandatory – Immediate Use)

FORM 1: INCIDENT REPORT

Date of Incident:			
Branch:			
Persons Involved:			
Description of Incident:			
Immediate Action Taken:			
Reported By:			
Signature:		Date:	

FORM 2: NON-COMPLIANCE REPORT

Date Identified:			
Module Breached (e.g. Module 2.5):			
Description of Breach:			
Risk Level:	☐ Low ☐ Medium ☐ High ☐ Critical		
Corrective Action Required:			
Responsible Person:			
Deadline:			
Supervisor Signature:		Date:	

ANNUAL FRANCHISE COMPLIANCE AUDIT CHECKLIST

(Mandatory – Franchisor Use)

GOVERNANCE (MODULE 1)

Franchise agreement on file
Manuals current and signed
Branding compliant

ADMINISTRATION & FINANCE (MODULE 2)

Trust account verified
80% daily deposits confirmed
MF Files complete
Receipts and invoices reconciled

OPERATIONS (MODULE 3)

Removal procedures compliant
Mortuary hygiene compliant
Documentation complete

STAFF COMPLIANCE (MODULE 3A)

Signed acknowledgements on file
Training completed
PPE available

CREMATION (MODULE 4)

Statutory documents complete
Identity verification confirmed
Ashes handling logged

REPATRIATION (MODULE 5)

Permits verified
Embalming certificates on file
Chain-of-custody records

FINDINGS & ACTIONS

Findings:			
Corrective Actions Required:			
Deadline:			
Auditor Name:			
Signature:		Date:	

BRANDED FRANCHISE MANUAL PDF PACK

Production & Rollout Specification

PURPOSE

This document defines the structure and branding requirements for the official Martin's Funerals Franchise Manual PDF Pack.

1. INCLUDED DOCUMENTS

The PDF pack shall include:

- Module 1 – Franchise Governance & Brand Control
- Module 2 – Administration, Finance & Trust Controls
- Module 3 – Operations, Compliance & Service Delivery
- Module 3A – Staff Operational Handbook
- Module 4 – Cremation Operations & Compliance - Training & Assessment Programme - Staff Acknowledgement Forms

2. BRANDING REQUIREMENTS

Official logo

Consistent colour palette

Professional typography

Footer with version control

"Confidential Franchise Document" watermark

3. VERSION CONTROL

Each PDF must include:

- Module name
- Version number
- Effective date
- Approval authority

4. DISTRIBUTION RULES

PDF access limited to authorised users

Staff handbooks issued separately

No unauthorised copying

FRANCHISE MANUAL ALIGNMENT FRAMEWORK

Modules 1–2 and 4+

PURPOSE

This document defines the **mandatory structure, tone, numbering, and compliance standard** to be applied when aligning all remaining Martin's Funerals Franchise Manual modules with the approved Module 3 and Module 3A standards.

This framework ensures: - Consistency across the entire franchise manual - Legal defensibility - Audit readiness - Clear separation between management and staff documents

GLOBAL STANDARDS (ALL MODULES)

STRUCTURE

Each module must follow this hierarchy: - Module Number & Title - Purpose & Scope - Governing Principles - Operational Sub-Modules - Compliance & Enforcement - Record Keeping - Ethics & Conduct

LANGUAGE RULES

Management manuals: **shall / must / may not**

Staff handbooks: **do / do not / always / never**

No informal or conversational language

No ambiguity

NUMBERING

Clause-based numbering (e.g. 2.4.3)

No bullet-only rules without clause references

MODULE 1 – CORPORATE & FRANCHISE GOVERNANCE (ALIGNMENT)

CONTENT SCOPE

Brand ownership & authority
Franchisee obligations
Use of trademarks and branding
Reporting duties
Disciplinary procedures

OUTPUT

Franchise Governance Manual (Management)
Staff Code of Conduct (Simplified)

MODULE 2 – ADMINISTRATION & FINANCIAL CONTROLS (ALIGNMENT)

CONTENT SCOPE

MF File lifecycle
Daily reports
Trust and savings accounts
Insurance, societies, pre-arrangements
Audit and reconciliation rules

OUTPUT

Financial & Administrative Manual
Staff Cash-Handling Guide

MODULES 4+ – SERVICE DELIVERY & SPECIALISED OPERATIONS

INCLUDED MODULES

Cremation Operations
Repatriation & Exportation
Religious & Cultural Services
Societies & Group Schemes
Pauper Funerals
Tombstones & Memorials
Estates & Aftercare

STRUCTURE

Each to be split into: - Franchise Operations Manual (Management) - Staff Operational Handbook (Simplified)

VERSION CONTROL & GOVERNANCE

Each module must include:

Version number

Effective date

Approval authority

No verbal policy overrides permitted